

E-Learning Usability Evaluation Questionnaire

Please, rate the usability of the e-learning courses¹. Browse around the different sections and mark the *number*, which you feel the e-learning course deserves for each parameter. If an item does not apply, mark the *Not Applicable* box (NA). Note that this evaluation is subjective in nature and there is no “right” or “wrong” answer.

Scale:

1=Strongly Disagree, 2=Disagree, 3=Neutral, 4=Agree, 5=Strongly Agree, NA= Not Applicable

Criteria	1 Strongly Disagree	2 Disagree	3 Neutral	4 Agree	5 Strongly Agree	NA
Content						
Terminology of the functions is used consistently throughout the e-learning course	1	2	3	4	5	
Abstract concepts (principles, formulas, rules, etc.) are illustrated with concrete, specific examples.	1	2	3	4	5	
The material in the course is accurate and current.	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses provide learners opportunities for reflection	1	2	3	4	5	
Vocabulary and terminology used are appropriate for the learners.	1	2	3	4	5	
All units/modules in the courses include an overview and a summary.	1	2	3	4	5	
Learning objectives of each module are quite (obvious) clear to the learners	1	2	3	4	5	
Content is organized in an appropriate sequence and in small modules for flexible learning.	1	2	3	4	5	
Learning & Support						
The courses motivate learners to request feedback from instructors, experts and peers, through e-mail or other online communications	1	2	3	4	5	
Feedback given (by exercises or simulations etc.) at any specific time is tailored to the content being studied, problem being solved, or task being completed by the learner.	1	2	3	4	5	

¹ This version of questionnaire uses the term course as the unit of analysis. Other more generic terms can also be used such as e-learning applications, e-learning platforms etc, when appropriate.

The courses enable learners to practice new knowledge and skills	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses offer tools (taking notes, job-aids, recourses, glossary etc.) that support learning	1	2	3	4	5	
Wherever appropriate, higher-order assessments (for example case studies, business simulations, discussion topics etc.) are provided rather than lower-order assessments (simple quizzes and tests)	1	2	3	4	5	
The course provide support for learner activities to allow working within existing competence while encountering meaningful chunks of knowledge	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses provide opportunities and support for learning through interaction with others (discussion or other collaborative activities).	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses include activities that are both individual-based and group-based.	1	2	3	4	5	
Visual Design						
The most important information on the screen is placed in areas most likely to attract the learner's attention	1	2	3	4	5	
Text and graphics are legible (readable).	1	2	3	4	5	
Fonts (style, color, saturation) are easy to read in both on-screen and in printed versions	1	2	3	4	5	
The online help or documentation is written clearly	1	2	3	4	5	
Navigation						
Learners can choose (easily) what parts of the course to access, the order and pace of studying	1	2	3	4	5	
Learners have control of their learning activities (studying, exercising, collaborating with other peers etc.).	1	2	3	4	5	
Learners always know where they are in the course.	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses allow the learner to leave whenever desired, but easily return to the closest logical point in the course.	1	2	3	4	5	
The course layout is sufficiently apparent so that learning can develop without extensive consultation of online help.	1	2	3	4	5	
It is clear what learners should do if they get stuck or have questions	1	2	3	4	5	

Accessibility						
The pages and other components of the course download quickly	1	2	3	4	5	
The course is easy to install, uninstall and launch	1	2	3	4	5	
The course is free from technical problems (hyperlink errors, programming errors etc.)	1	2	3	4	5	
Interactivity						
The courses use games, simulations, role-playing activities, and case studies to gain the attention, and maintain motivation of learners.	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses provide meaningful interactions (for example embedded quizzes, tests etc) when there are long sections of text	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses provide access to a range of resources (web links, case studies, simulations, problems, examples) appropriate to the learning context and for use in the real world	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses engage learners in tasks that are closely aligned with the learning goals and objectives.	1	2	3	4	5	
Media are used appropriately so as to assist in highlighting and learning critical concepts rather than merely entertaining or possibly distracting learners.	1	2	3	4	5	
Self Assessment & Learnability						
Learners can predict the general result of clicking on each button or link	1	2	3	4	5	
Learners can start the course (locate it, install plug-ins, register, access starting page) using only online assistance	1	2	3	4	5	
It is clear to learners what is to be accomplished and what will be gained from its use	1	2	3	4	5	
The courses provide opportunities for self-assessments (post tests and other assessments) that advance learners' achievements according to the learning objectives	1	2	3	4	5	
Embedded exercises and other types of assessment (simulations etc.) prepare learners to apply new knowledge and skills in their everyday job conditions.	1	2	3	4	5	
Motivation to learn						
The course incorporates novel characteristics	1	2	3	4	5	
The course stimulates further inquiry	1	2	3	4	5	
The course is enjoyable and interesting	1	2	3	4	5	

The course provides instruction/training that matches with learners' experience	1	2	3	4	5	
The course meets learners' needs	1	2	3	4	5	
The course provides learner chances to make decisions	1	2	3	4	5	
The course provides learner with frequent and varied learning activities that increase learning success.	1	2	3	4	5	
Learning requirements, criteria for learning success are clear within the course	1	2	3	4	5	
The course provides learners opportunities to use new skills in authentic situations	1	2	3	4	5	
The course assists learners to have positive feelings about their accomplishments	1	2	3	4	5	

The above questionnaire was developed by Dr. Panagiotis Zaharias during his doctoral research. Please cite as:

Zaharias, P. (2004). A Usability Evaluation Method for E-Learning Courses, Unpublished PhD Dissertation, Department of Management Science and Technology, Athens University of Economics and Business.

Related publications:

Zaharias, P. and Poulymenakou, A. (2009). Developing a usability evaluation method for e-learning applications: beyond functional usability. *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction* Vol 25 (1), January 2009, 75 – 98.

Zaharias, P. (2006). A Usability Evaluation Method for e-learning: Focus on Motivation to Learn. In Extended Abstracts of Conference on *Human Factors in Computing Systems – CHI 2006*.